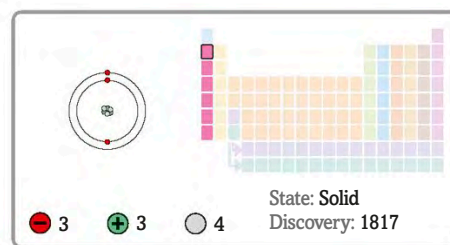


3
Li

Lithium



Forms

This water contains tiny amounts of dissolved lithium minerals.

Drinking water



Oyster mushrooms

These mushrooms absorb lithium from the soil.

Pale quartz

Prawn

Prawns and other shellfish absorb lithium from seawater.

Lepidolite

Purple crystals containing lithium

Bar of pure lithium refined in a laboratory

Shiny pure lithium becomes dull when it is exposed to air.

Petalite

Grey-white crystals

Lithium is the the lightest of all metals: in fact, it can easily float on water. Pure lithium is very reactive and exists in nature only in minerals, such as **lepidolite** and **petalite**. Many lithium minerals dissolve well in **water**, and the world's seawater

contains millions of tonnes of dissolved lithium. Lithium is found in many foods, such as **mushrooms, prawns**, nuts, and seeds. It also has many everyday applications. Glass composed of lithium is resistant to heat and is used in scientific equipment, such as **mirrors inside**